



FOSS Bytes

SFCL sues 14 brands over GPL violations

Samsung, JVC and Best Buy are among the 14 consumer electronics companies named in a copyright infringement lawsuit filed on December 14 in New York by the Software Freedom Law Centre (SFLC). The suit was filed on behalf of the Software Freedom Conservancy (Conservancy), the non-profit corporate home of the popular software application BusyBox and many other FOSS projects. The suit charges each of the defendants with selling products containing BusyBox in violation of the terms of its GPLv2 licence.

BusyBox is a common component of a growing number of household devices, including Best Buy's Insignia Blu Ray DVD Player, Samsung HDTVs, and more than a dozen other products that the defendants have continued to sell without the permission of the software's copyright holders. The SFLC confirmed BusyBox violations in nearly 20 separate products cited in the complaint and gave each defendant ample time to comply with the requirements of the license. Though the scope of this lawsuit is unprecedented in that it includes 14 defendants, the SFLC's primary goal is to encourage companies to join the software freedom movement, according to the body.



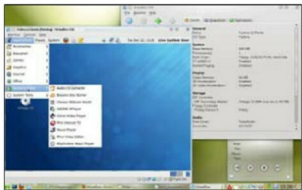
Teleportation capability debuts in VirtualBox 3.1

Sun Microsystems has announced a significant new version of Sun VirtualBox. Version 3.1 introduces the virtualisation industry's first 'Teleportation' capability, allowing running virtual machines to be moved, uninterrupted between disparate hosts—including those on different

operating systems, different classes of computers (e.g., server to client) and even different CPUs (e.g., Intel to AMD). To download the freely available Sun VirtualBox software, visit: <http://www.sun.com/software/products/virtualbox/get.jsp>.

VirtualBox 3.1 also improves execution

speed, with optimised memory handling that delivers performance increases; network performance with increased throughput, while reducing CPU cycles through a new high-speed, para-virtualised network driver; and improved display performance via a new 2D video acceleration feature for Windows guests. In addition, VirtualBox 3.1 offers new more powerful snapshotting features that help administrators move a virtual machine back or forward in time to any arbitrary snapshot state. Download the latest stable version (VirtualBox 3.1.2) from www.virtualbox.org.



Oracle's commitments to users of MySQL

To engage in a constructive discussion with the European Commission over its concerns regarding the Oracle-Sun Microsystems transaction, and in particular the maintenance of MySQL as a competitive force in the database market, Oracle has announced commitments to users of MySQL. Some of these include: continued availability of storage engine APIs; a commitment to enhance MySQL in the future under the GPL; increased spending on MySQL research and development; continued maintenance of the MySQL Reference Manual; and a commitment to preserve customer choice for support. The complete details are available at www.oracle.com/us/corporate/press/042364.

French Army moves to Thunderbird

The French government is moving to FOSS such as GNU/Linux instead of Windows and OpenOffice.org instead of Microsoft Office, according to recent reports. The French military, in particular, is now using the Thunderbird client on over 80,000 computers as it finds the e-mail client more secure than Microsoft Outlook. The department that found Mozilla's open source design permitted them to build extensions for security, while Microsoft's proprietary software did not enable the building of extensions. The military has released some of its work to the public under the name 'TrustedBird' and co-branded it with Mozilla. The French government is also reportedly moving to other open source software.